Microsoft

Power Automate Bootcamp: Basic

Hands-On Lab Guide

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Microsoft Power Platform

Contents

Demo 1: Introduction to Creating a Flow

In this instructor-led demo, we will walk through the basics of Power Automate by creating a simple **instant cloud flow**. The flow will be manually triggered and use the **MSN Weather connector** to fetch current weather for a specified location. We'll also show how to view outputs in JSON format and send yourself a Teams message using the 48:notes trick.

Objectives

After this demo, participants will be able to:

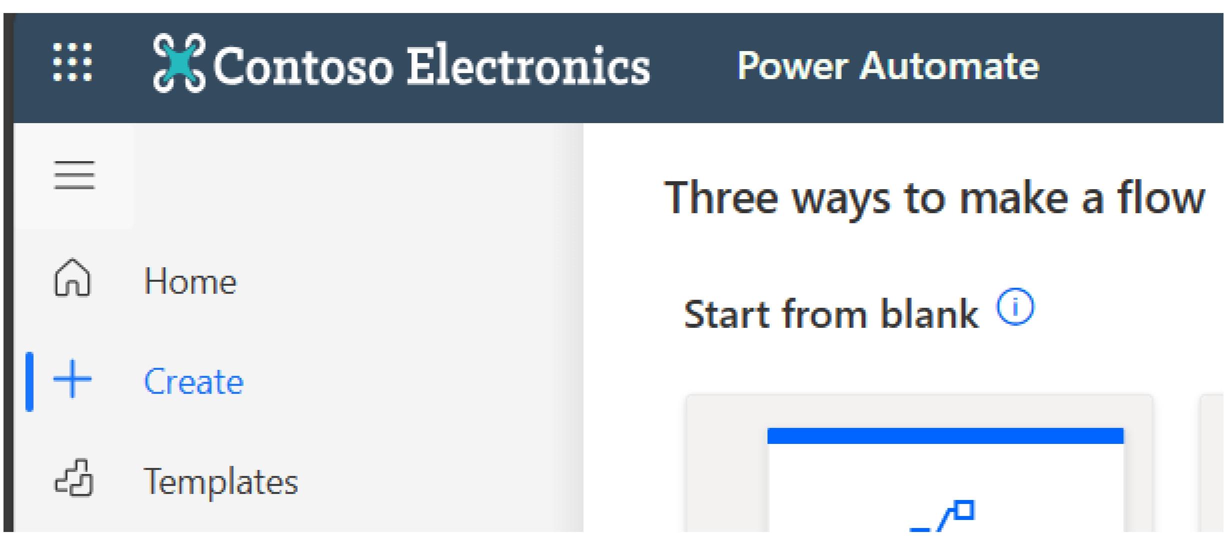
- Identify the different types of flows in Power Automate
- Create and manually trigger a basic cloud flow
- Add and configure connectors and their actions
- Authenticate connectors during flow setup
- Interpret JSON output from flow actions
- Use 48:notes to send a Teams message to themselves

Estimated time to complete this lab

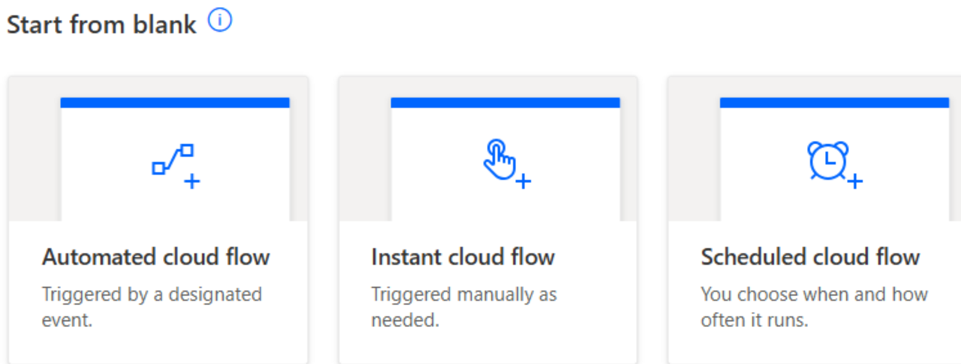
20 mins (Demo Only)

Task 1: Understanding Flow Types and Connectors

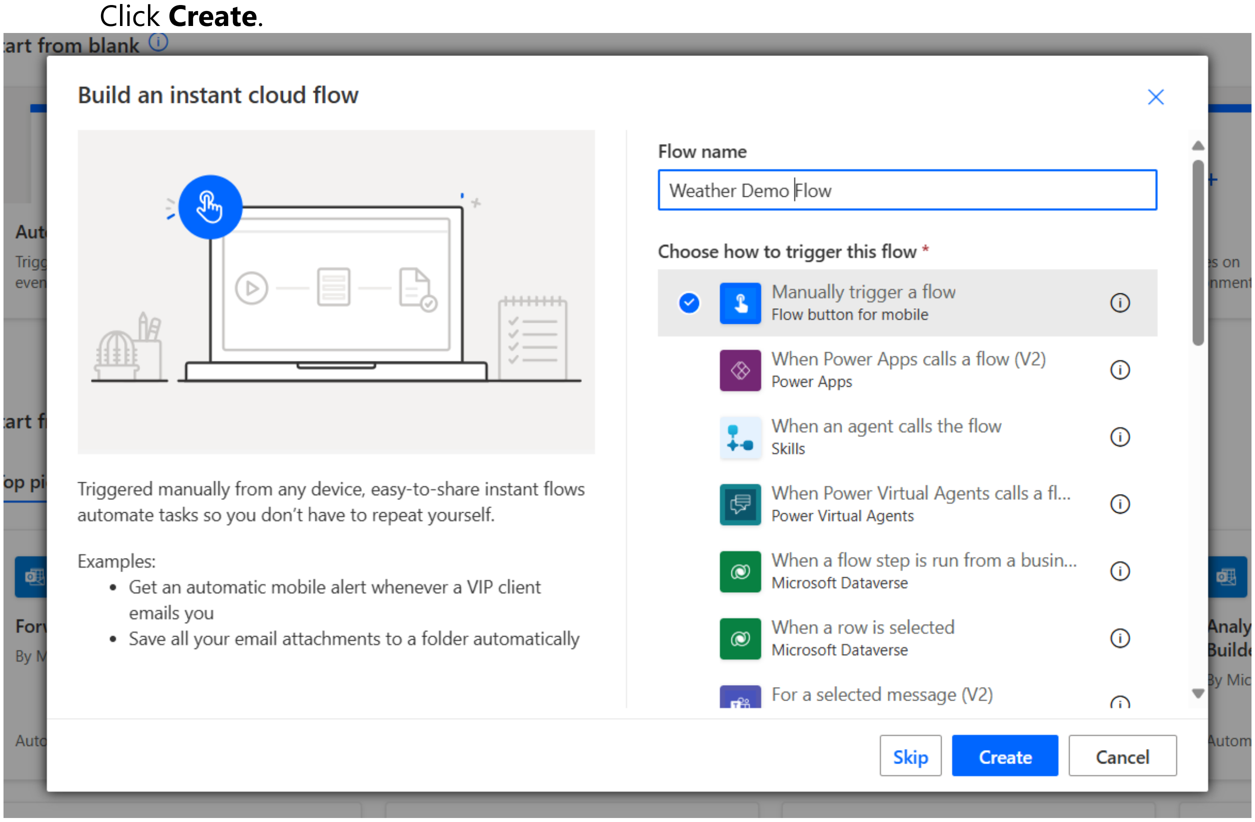
1. From the [Power Automate homepage](), click **Create** from the left navigation.



2. Review the types of flows:
    - **Automated cloud flow** – triggered by external events
    - **Instant cloud flow** – manually triggered
    - **Scheduled cloud flow** – runs on a timer
    - **Desktop flow** – for RPA use
    - **Business process flow** – guides business users through processes

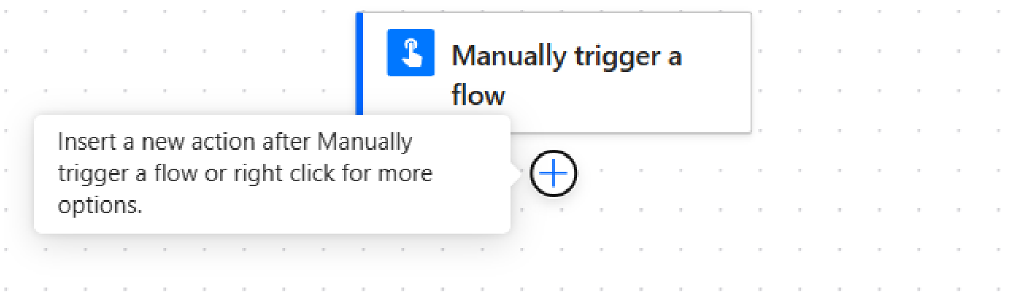


3. Select **Instant cloud flow**, name it “Weather Demo Flow”, and choose **Manually trigger a flow**.
   Click **Create**.

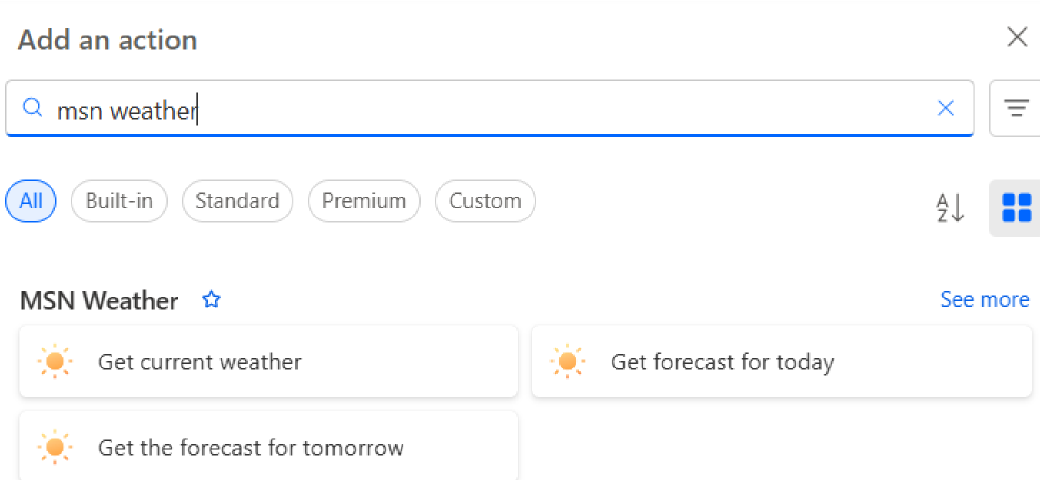


(Optional)Task 2A: Add and Authenticate MSN Weather Connector

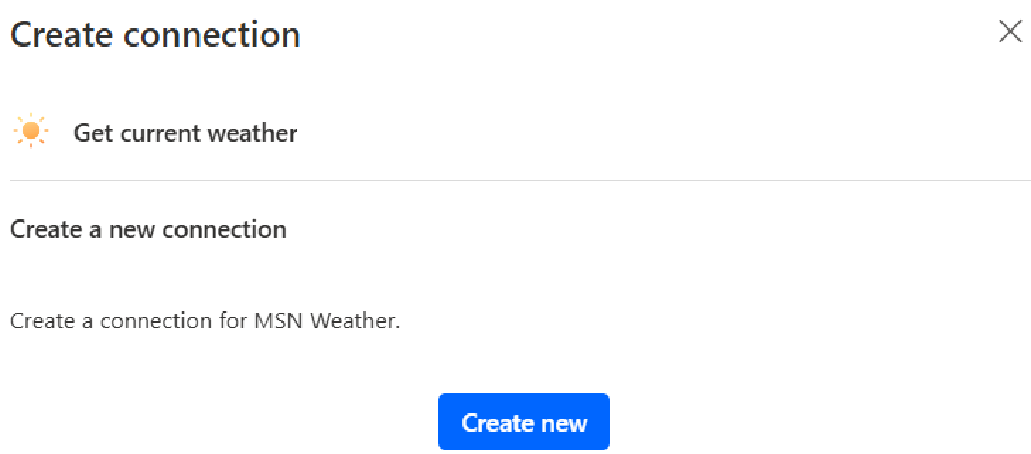
1. Click **+ New Step**



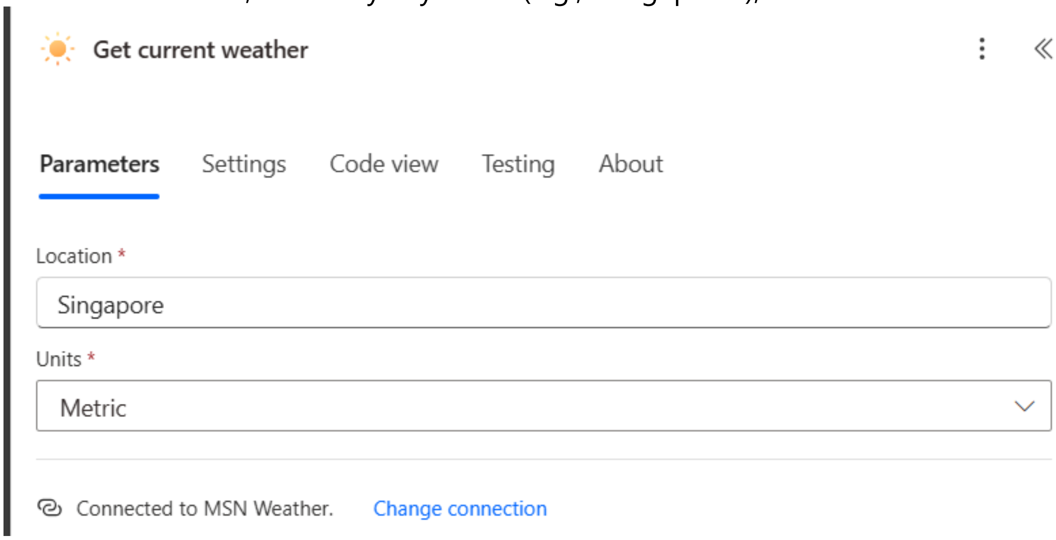
2. Search for **MSN Weather** and select **Get current weather**



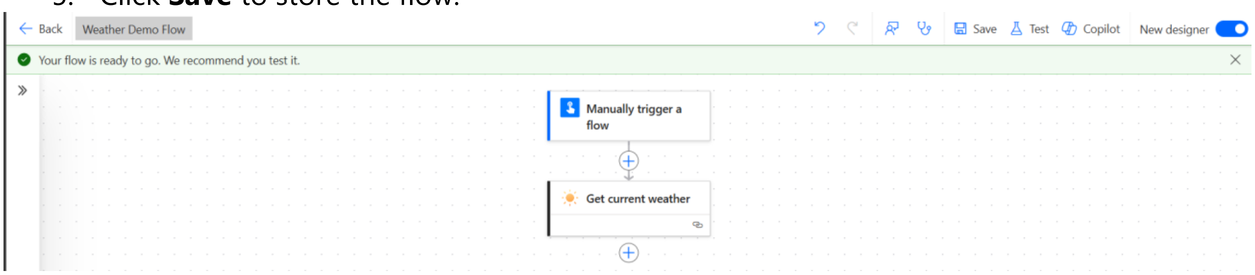
3. If prompted, Create connection, sign in and grant access to authenticate the connector.



4. In the **Location** field, enter any city name (e.g., "Singapore"), set units to “Metric”.

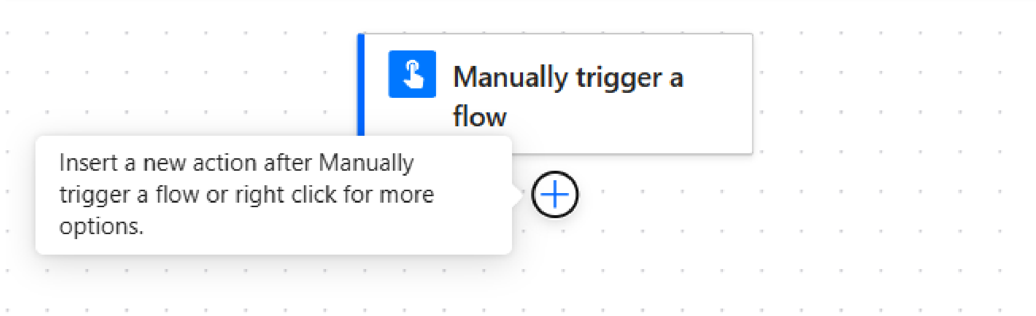


5. Click **Save** to store the flow.

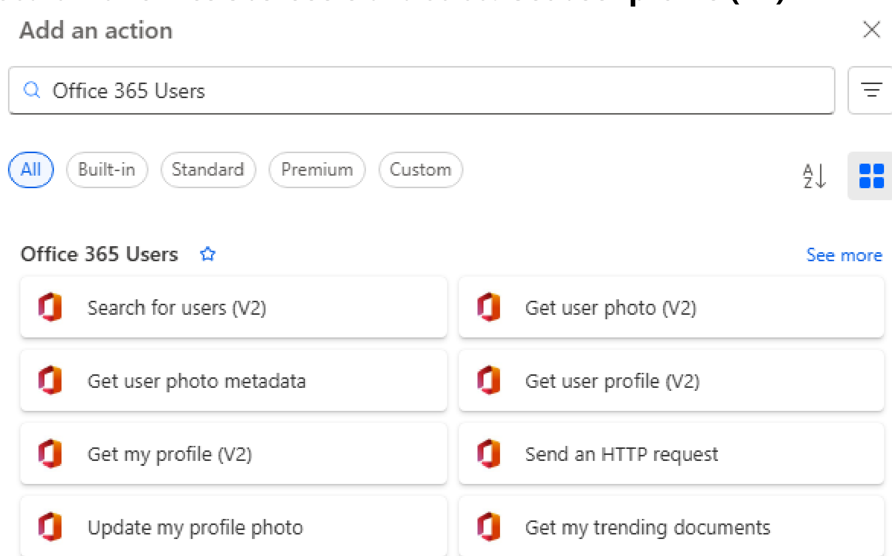


(Optional)Task 2B: Add and Authenticate Office 365 Profile Connector

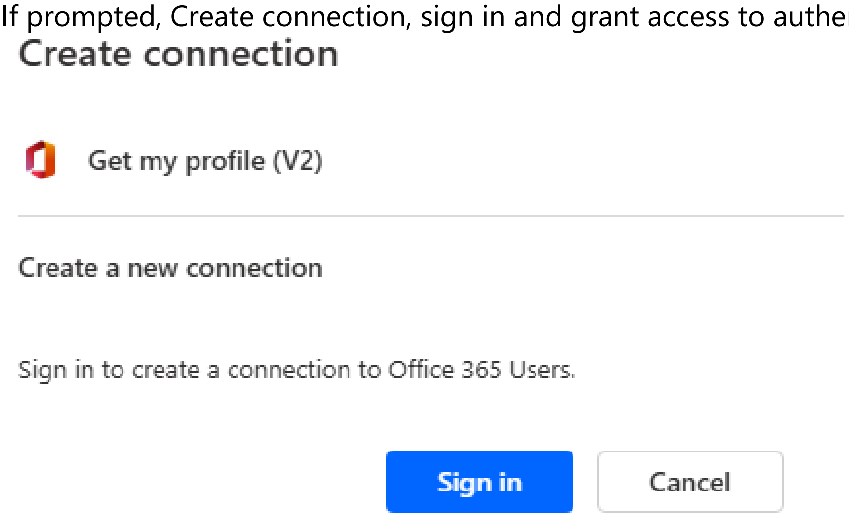
1. Click **+ New Step**



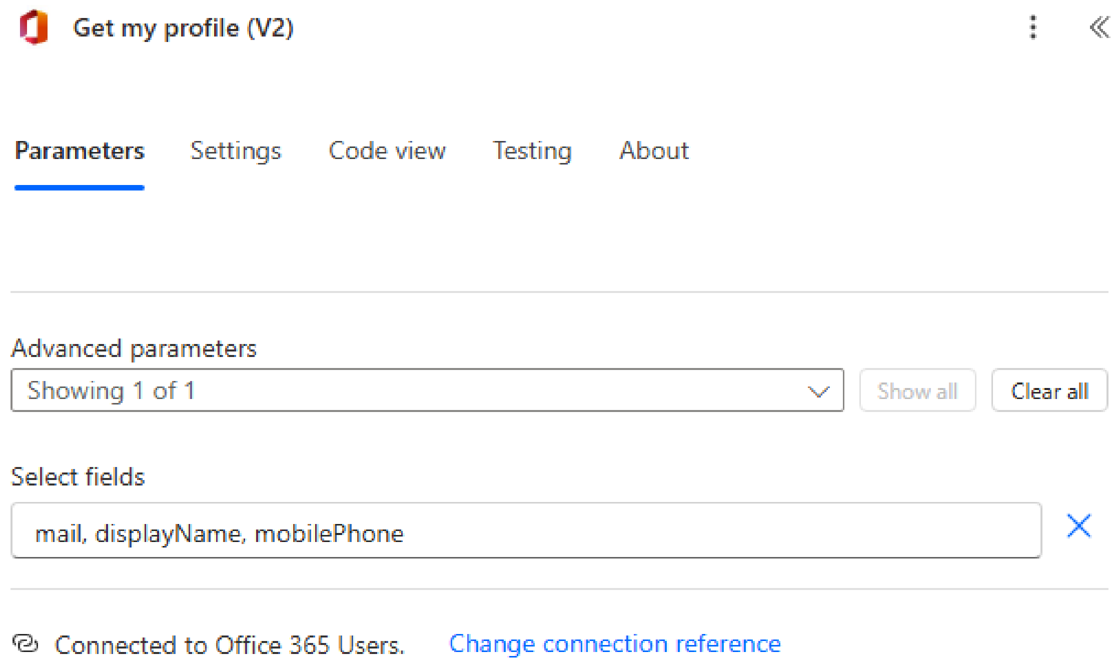
2. Search for **Office 365 Users** and select **Get user profile (V2)**



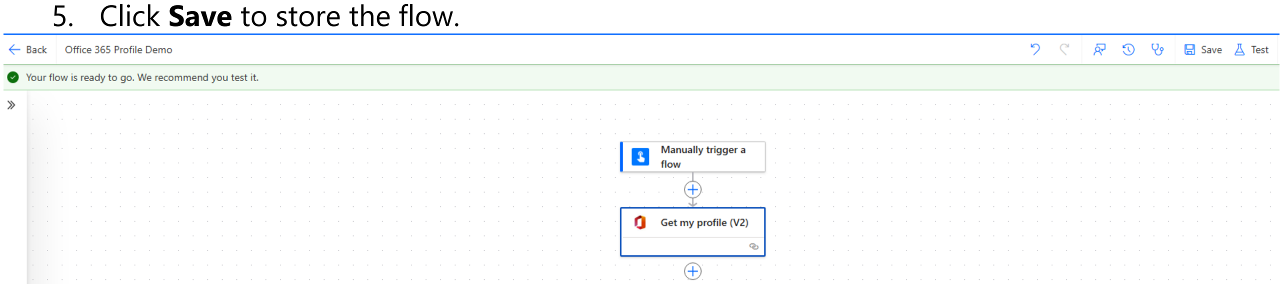
3. If prompted, Create connection, sign in and grant access to authenticate the connector.



4. In the **Select Fields** field, enter the following mail, displayName, mobilePhone.



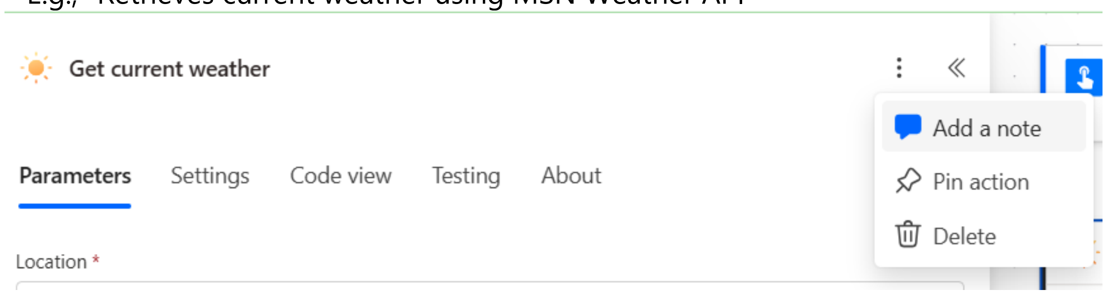
5. Click **Save** to store the flow.

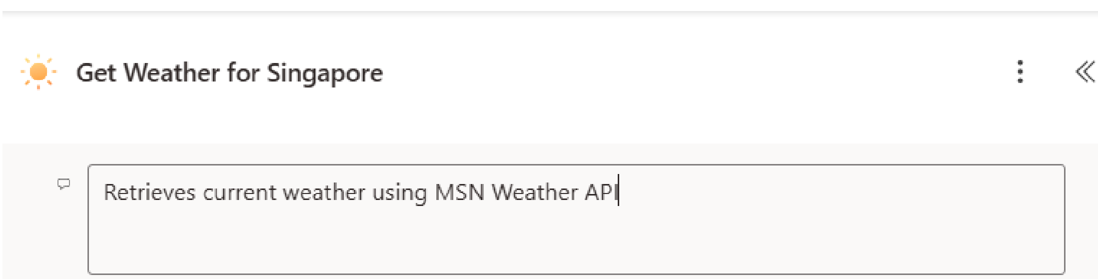


(Optional)Task 3A: Rename and Add Notes

1. Click title and you can rename the Card.
   E.g., rename the action to Get Weather for Singapore

2. Click on the **ellipsis (···)** on the step and select **Rename** Use **Add a note** to describe the step's function.
   E.g., "Retrieves current weather using MSN Weather API"





Task 4: Test and Understand the Output

1. Click **Test**, choose **Manually**, and then **Save & Test, Run Flow, Done**.

2. After the flow runs, expand the MSN Weather step.
   You will see **Raw Outputs** in **JSON** format.

3. JSON (JavaScript Object Notation) is a structured way to store and transmit data using **key-value pairs**.
   Example:

JSON:

```
{
  "location": "Singapore",
  "temperature": 30,
  "condition": "Cloudy"
}
```

This allows Power Automate to extract and use specific values like *temperature* or *condition*.

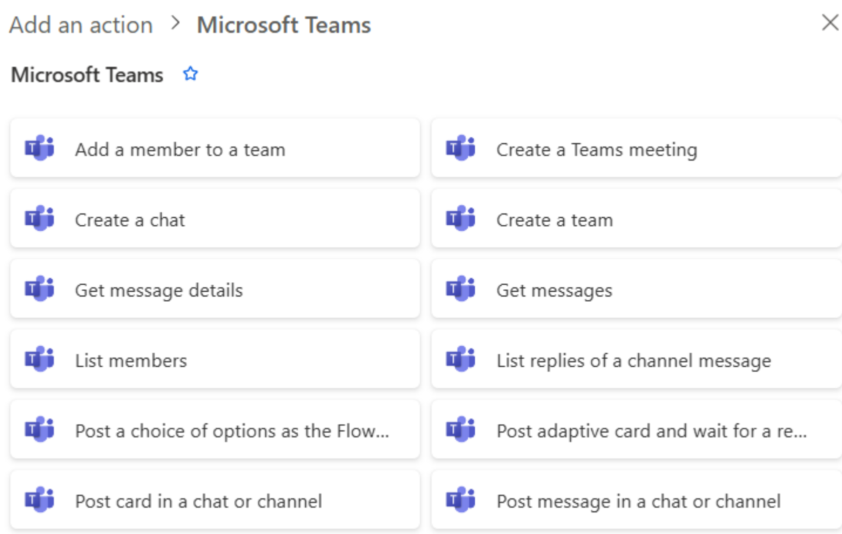
Get_Weather_for_Singapore

Get_Weather_for_Singapore


```
    "body": {
      "responses": {
        "weather": {
          "alerts": [],
          "current": {
            "baro": 1010,
            "cap": "Partly sunny",
            "capAbbr": "Partly sunny",
            "daytime": "d",
            "dewPt": 24,
            "feels": 36,
            "rh": 69,
            "icon": 3,
            "symbol": "d2000",
            "pvdrIcon": "3",
            "urlIcon": "http://img-s-msn-com.akamaized.net/tenan
            "wx": "RA",
            "sky": "BKN",
            "temp": 30,
            "tempDesc": 9,
            "utci": 36,
            "uv": 7,
            "uvDesc": "High",
            "vis": 10,
            "windDir": 50,
            "windSpd": 12,
            "windTh": 22,
            "windGust": 21,
            "created": "2025-06-16T06:06:08+00:00",
            "pvdrCap": "Partly sunny",
            "aqi": 106,
            "aqiSeverity": "Poor air quality",
            "aqLevel": 30,
            "primaryPollutant": "PM2.5 0.0 µg/m³",
            "aqiValidTime": "2025-06-16T12:00:00+00:00",
            "richCaps": [],
            "cloudCover": 53
          },
```

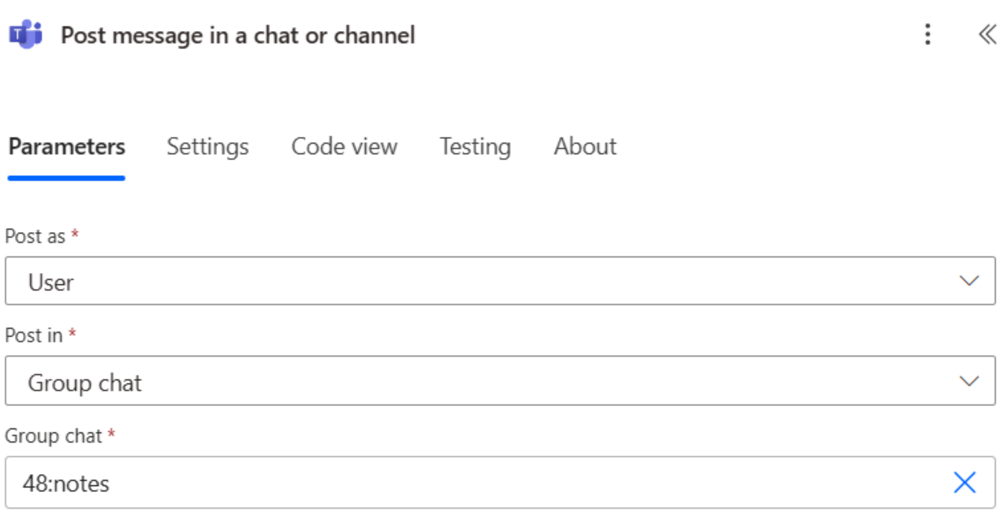
Task 5: Send a Teams Message to Yourself

1. Add a new step and select **Microsoft Teams → Post message in a chat or channel**



2. Choose Post as: **User**,
   and Post in: **Group chat**,
   under Group Chat input→ Enter Custom Value: 48:notes

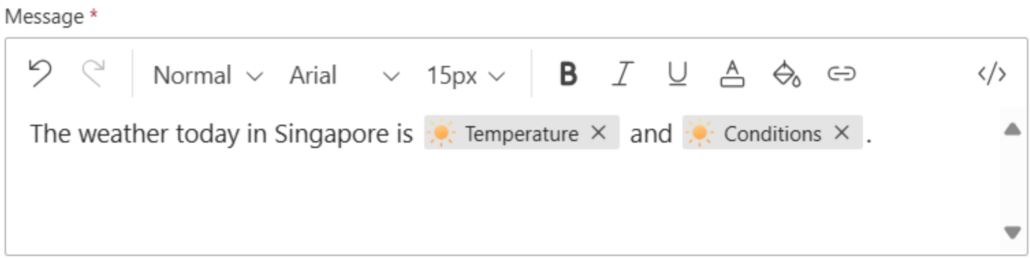
This sends a message to yourself in Teams.



3. In the **Message** field, add something like: **For Task 3A**

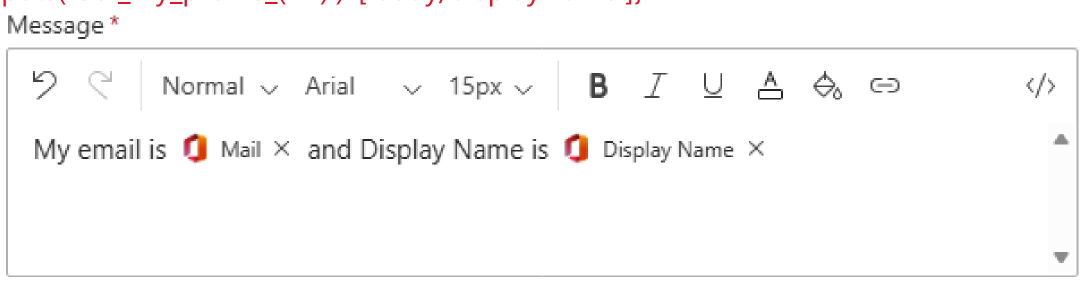
The weather today in Singapore is @{body('Get_current_weather')?['temperature']}°C and @{body('Get_current_weather')?['weatherText']}.

(Use Copilot to help format this if needed.)

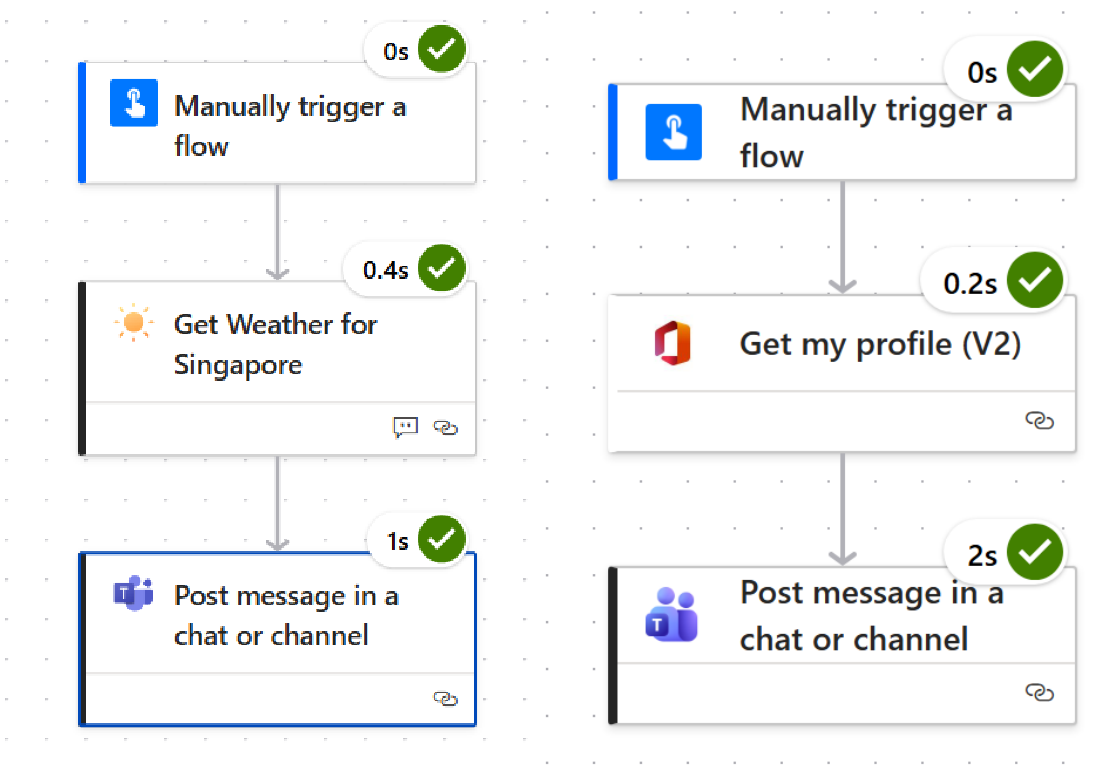


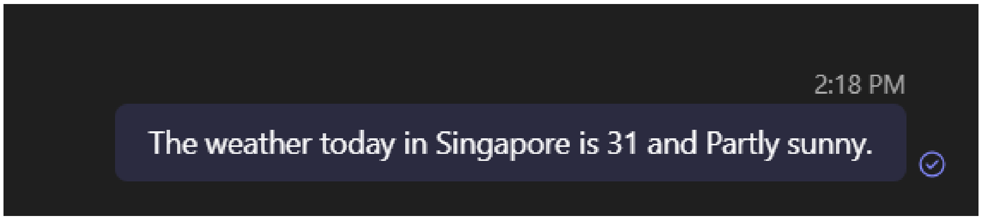
For Task 3B

My email is @{outputs('Get_my_profile_(V2)')?['body/mail']} and Display Name is @{outputs('Get_my_profile_(V2)')?['body/displayName']}



4. Save and run the flow again. Check your Teams app to confirm the message was sent.




2:18 PM
The weather today in Singapore is 31 and Partly sunny.


My email is admin@M365x04349104.onmicrosoft.com and Display Name is MOD Administrator

-- **End of Task** --

Exercise 1: Creating Your First Flow with Excel and Office 365 Connectors

In this hands-on exercise, participants will create an **instant cloud flow** that adds a new row to an Excel file stored in OneDrive. The flow will be manually triggered and use dynamic values such as the participant's profile information and current date.

Objectives

After completing this exercise, participants will be able to:

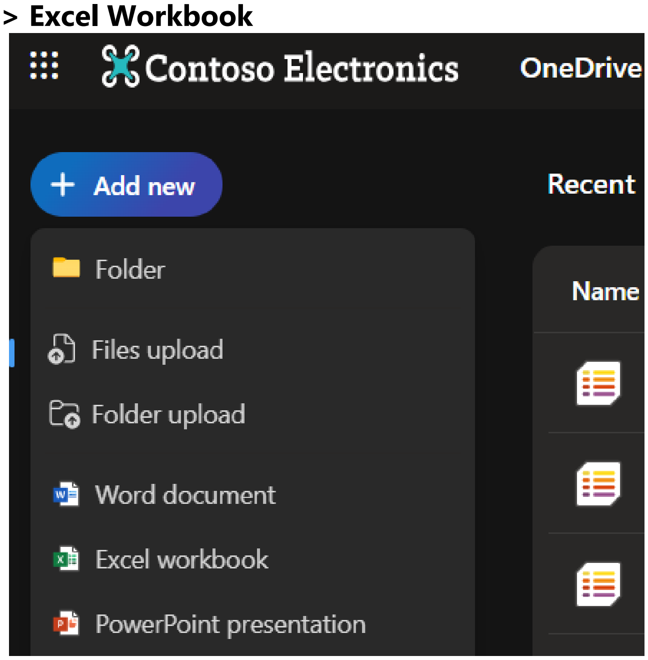
- Create and configure an Excel table in OneDrive
- Build a manually triggered flow using Power Automate
- Use the **Excel Online (Business)** and **Office 365 Users** connectors
- Populate Excel with dynamic values using flow expressions
- Format dates using the formatDateTime() function

Estimated Time

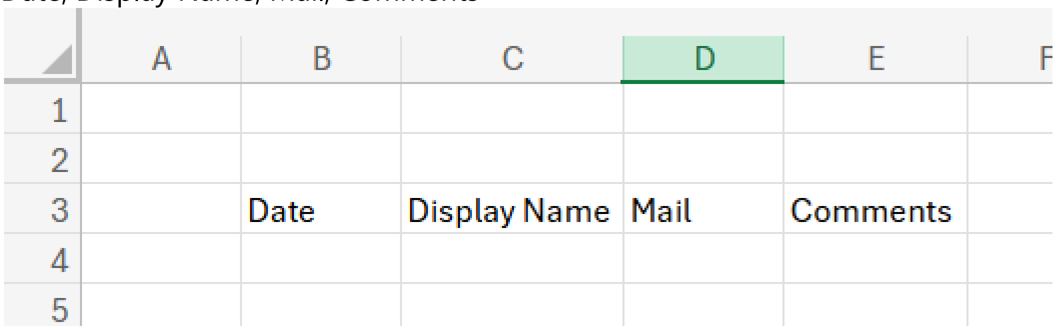
40–50 mins

Task 1: Creating an Excel Table in OneDrive

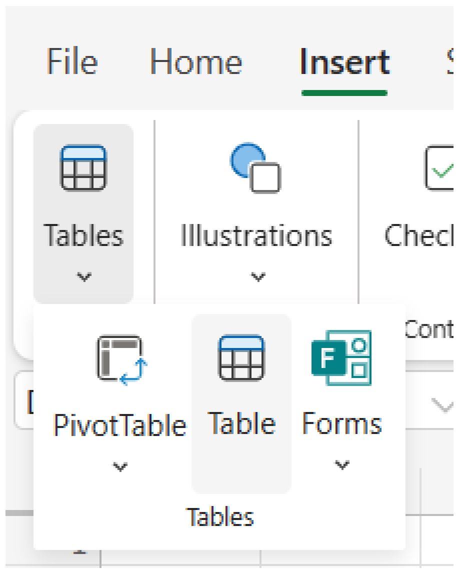
1. Go to **OneDrive for Business** and create a new Excel workbook.
   Click **+Add New > Excel Workbook**

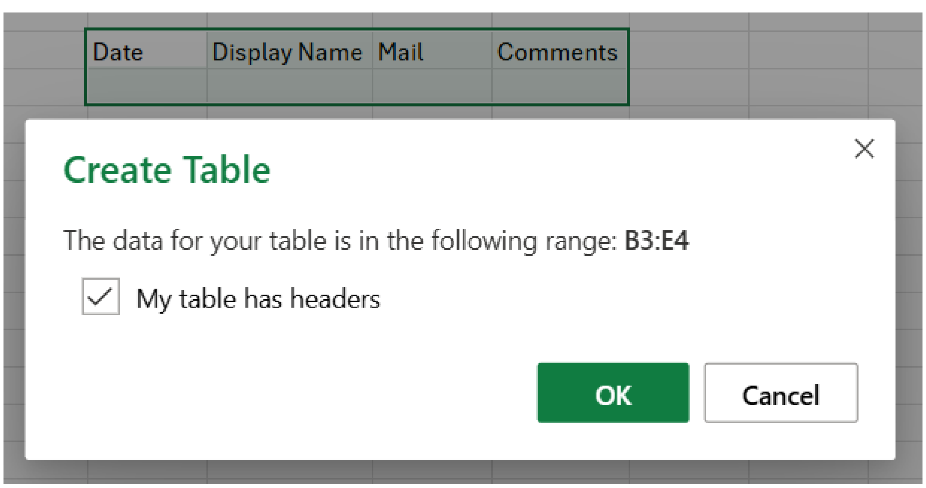


2. Inside the workbook, create the following columns:
   Date, Display Name, Mail, Comments

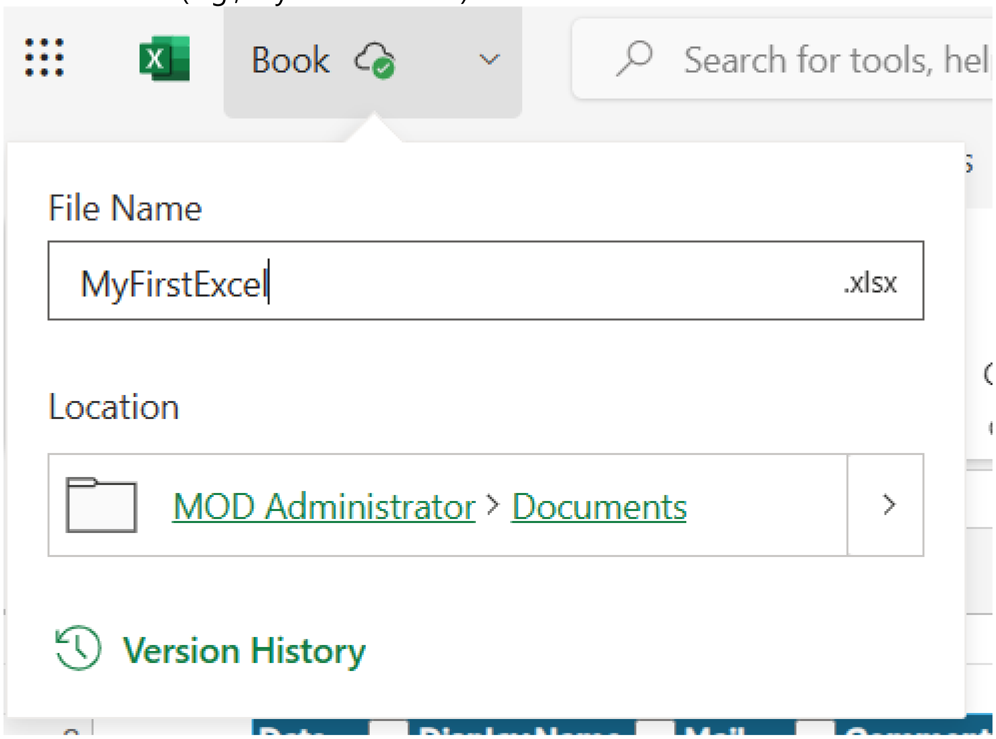


3. Select the data and insert a table via **Insert > Table**
   Ensure **"My table has headers"** is checked

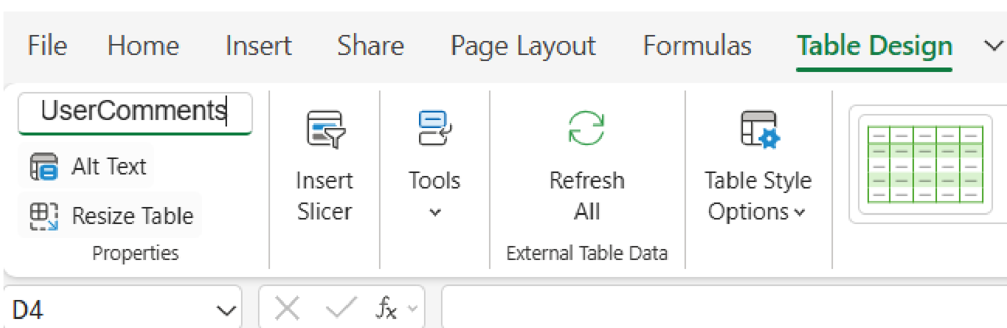




4. Rename the file (e.g., MyFirstExcel.xlsx)



5. (Optional) Click inside the table, under the Table Design Tab and rename it from Table1 to something meaningful (e.g., UserComments)



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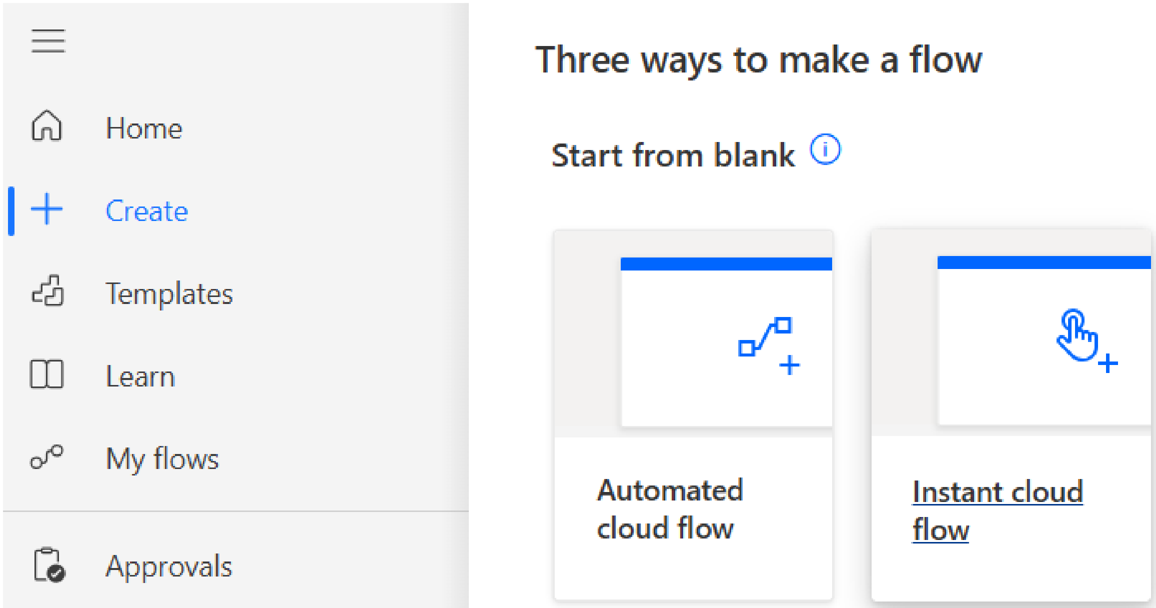
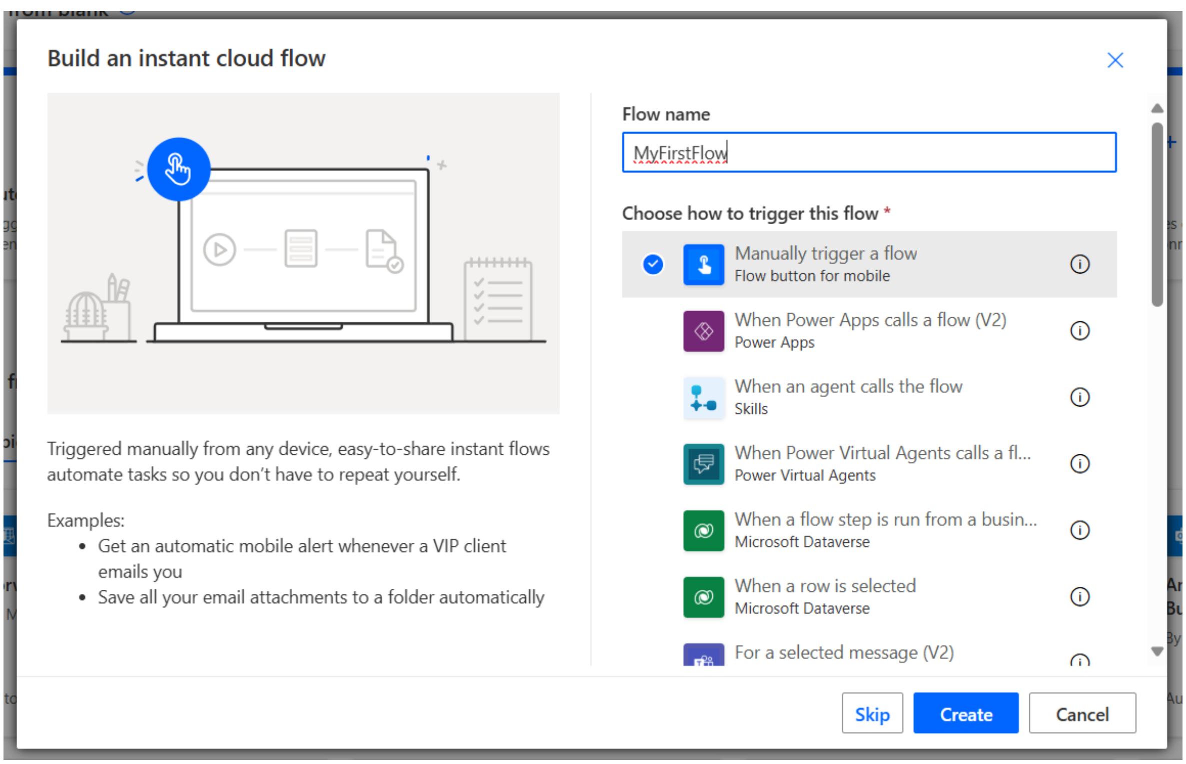
Task 2: Creating a Manually Triggered Flow

1. Go to Power Automate and click **Create > Instant cloud flow**

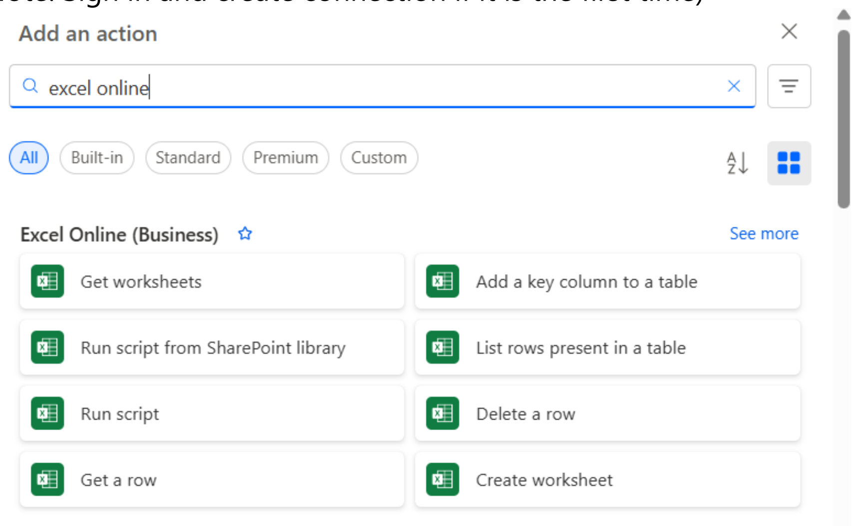


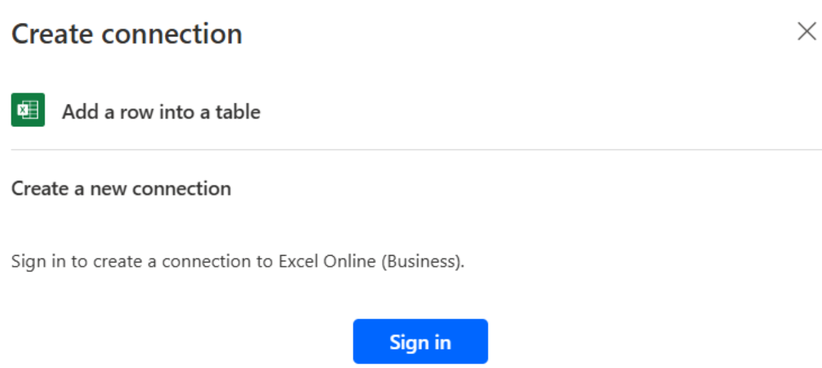
2. Name your flow: **MyFirstFlow**

Choose the trigger: **Manually trigger a flow**, then click **Create**

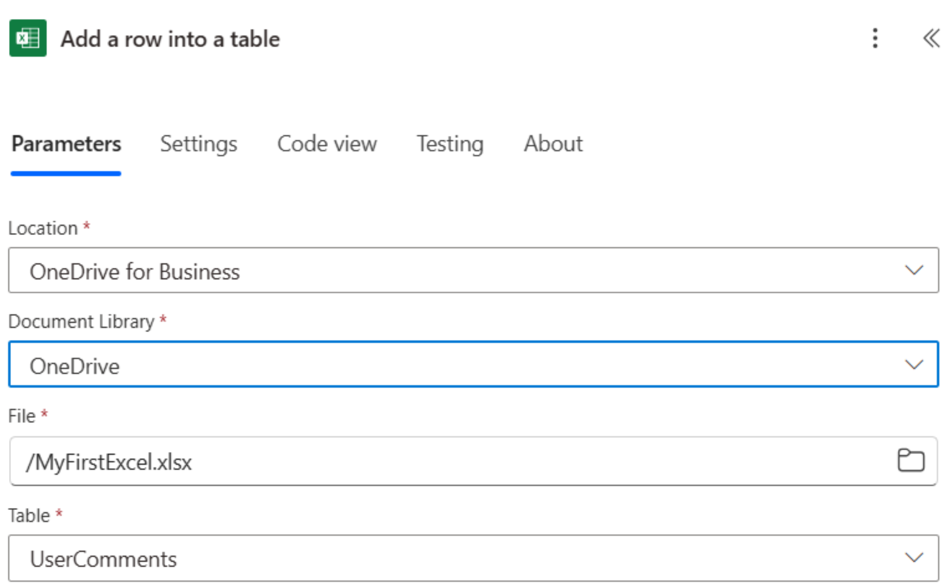


3. Click **+ New Step**, search for **Excel Online (Business)**, and choose **Add a row into a table** (Note: Sign in and create connection if it is the first time)



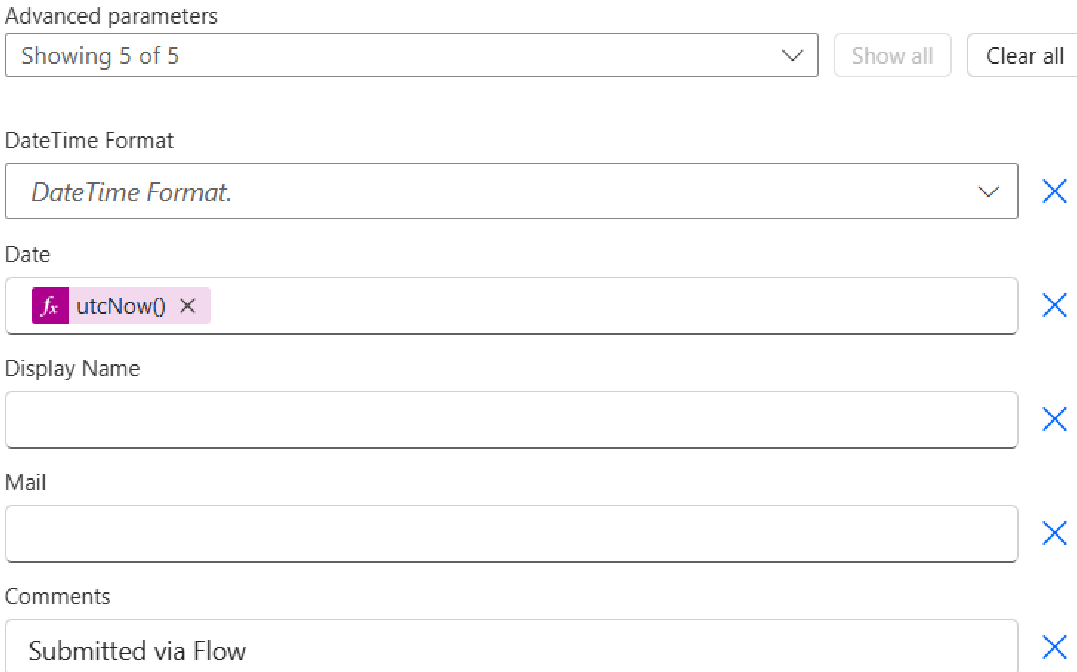


4. Select your OneDrive Excel file and the table name as shown below



5. In the card under Advanced parameters select **Show all**, populate values:

- **Date** → utcNow()
- **Display Name** → Leave blank for now
- **Mail** → Leave blank for now
- **Comments** → Type a test comment (e.g., "Submitted via flow")

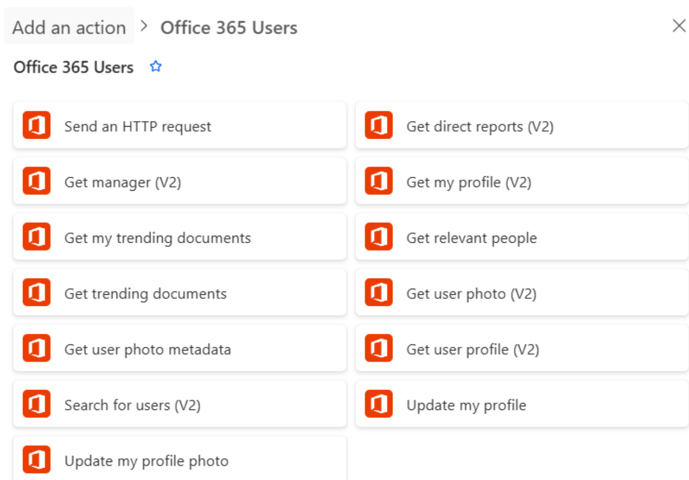


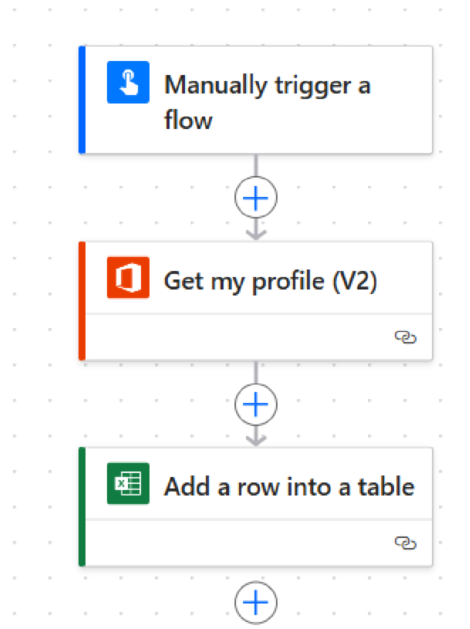
6. Click **Save** and **Test** the flow. Confirm a row is added to your Excel file.

Date	Display Name	Mail	Comments
2025-06-16T06:41:04.9696901Z			Submitted via Flow

Task 3: Using Office 365 Connector for Dynamic Data

1. Add a new step between Trigger and Excel action: search for **Office 365 Users** and select **Get my profile (V2)**





2. Return to your Excel step and update the fields:

- **Display Name** → Use dynamic content Display Name
- **Mail** → Use dynamic content Mail

3. Improve the **Date** format. Replace utcNow() with:

formatDateTime(utcNow(), 'd-M-yyyy')

This shows the date in a readable format.

4. Save and test the flow again. Verify that the Excel row now includes your name, email, and formatted date.

Date	Display Name	Mail	Comments
2025-06-16T06:41:04.9696901Z			Submitted via Flow
16-6-2025	MOD Administrat	admin@M365x08449821.onmicrosoft.com	Submitted via Flow

-- **End of Task** --

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Exercise 2: Sending Teams Messages Using Excel Data

In this exercise, you'll retrieve data from the Excel table created in **Exercise 1** and send that information to yourself via **Microsoft Teams**. This helps reinforce using dynamic content, working with connector outputs, and understanding loop behavior when multiple rows are involved.

Objectives

After completing this exercise, participants will be able to:

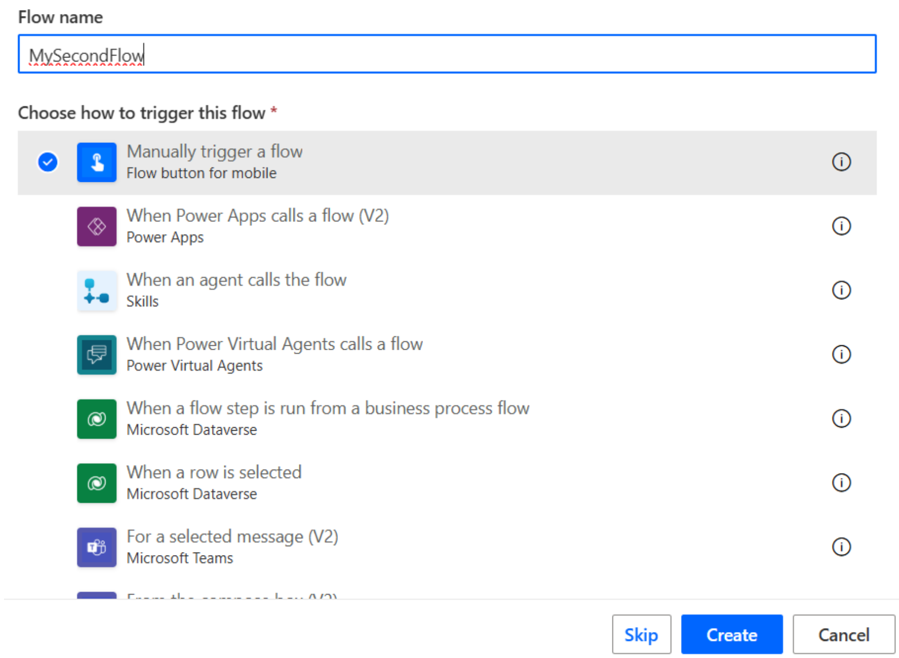
- Retrieve rows from an Excel table using Power Automate
- Use dynamic content from Excel in downstream steps
- Send a Teams message to themselves using 48:notes
- Understand how **Apply to each** is triggered when dealing with multiple rows
- (Optional) Format the data into an HTML table for cleaner presentation

Estimated Time

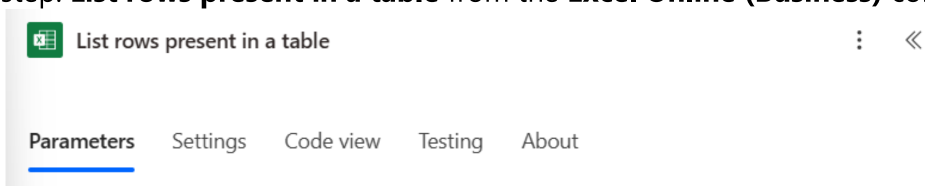
30–40 mins

Task 1: Create a New Flow to Retrieve Excel Data

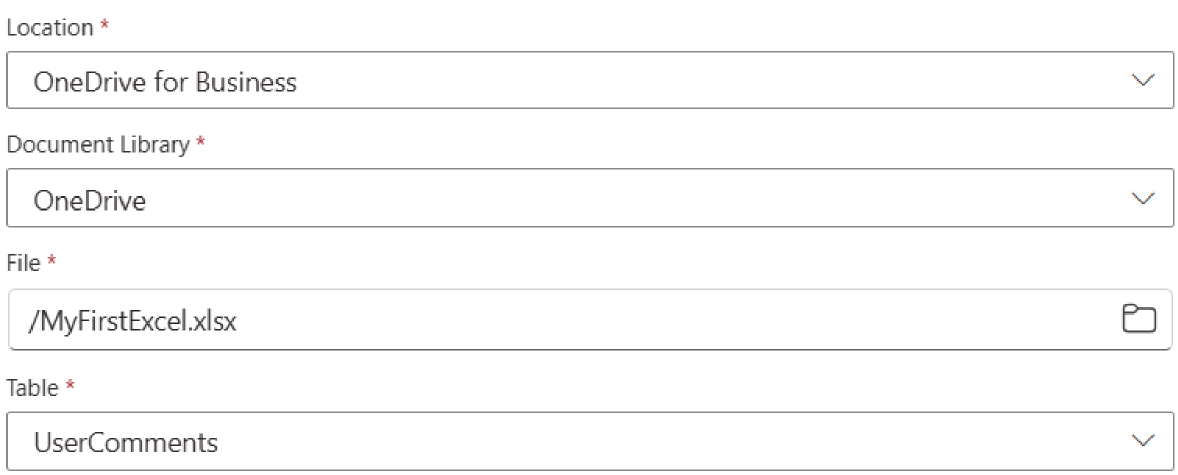
1. Go to Power Automate and create a new **instant cloud flow,** Name it: **MySecondFlow** Choose **Manually trigger a flow**, then click **Create**



2. Add a step: **List rows present in a table** from the **Excel Online (Business)** connector



3. Select the Excel file and table you created in **Exercise 1** (e.g., *MyFirstExcel.xlsx* and "*UserComments*" table)



4. Save and test the flow to confirm rows are being retrieved

List_rows_present_in_a_table

List_rows_present_in_a_table


```
        "x-ms-dlp-gu": "-|-",
        "x-ms-dlp-ef": "-|-/-|-|-",
        "x-ms-mip-sl": "-|-|-",
        "Timing-Allow-Origin": "*",
        "x-ms-apihub-cached-response": "false",
        "x-ms-apihub-obo": "false",
        "Date": "Mon, 16 Jun 2025 07:05:08 GMT",
        "Content-Type": "application/json; odata.metadata=minimal; odata.st
        "Content-Length": "843",
        "Expires": "-1"
    },
    "body": {
        "@odata.context": "https://excelonline-ea.azconn-ea-001.p.azurewebs
        "value": [
            {
                "@odata.etag": "",
                "ItemInternalId": "556b6085-033f-4633-a54d-5fcfdcdde16b",
                "Date": "",
                "Display Name": "",
                "Mail": "",
                "Comments": ""
            },
            {
                "@odata.etag": "",
                "ItemInternalId": "55de1a0d-6553-4d11-8c6b-468a2297c2a6",
                "Date": "2025-06-16T06:41:04.9696901Z",
                "Display Name": "",
                "Mail": "",
                "Comments": "Submitted via Flow"
            },
            {
                "@odata.etag": "",
                "ItemInternalId": "c14372bb-9130-43ef-b1f1-009cdec1a3d4",
                "Date": "16-6-2025",
                "Display Name": "MOD Administrator",
                "Mail": "admin@M365x08449821.onmicrosoft.com",
                "Comments": "Submitted via Flow"
```

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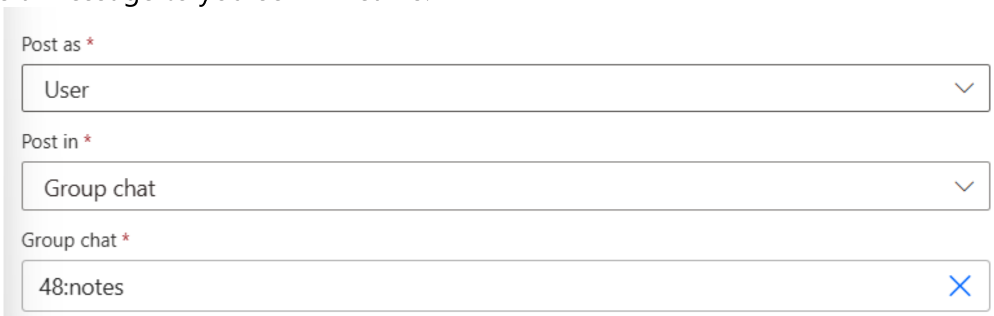
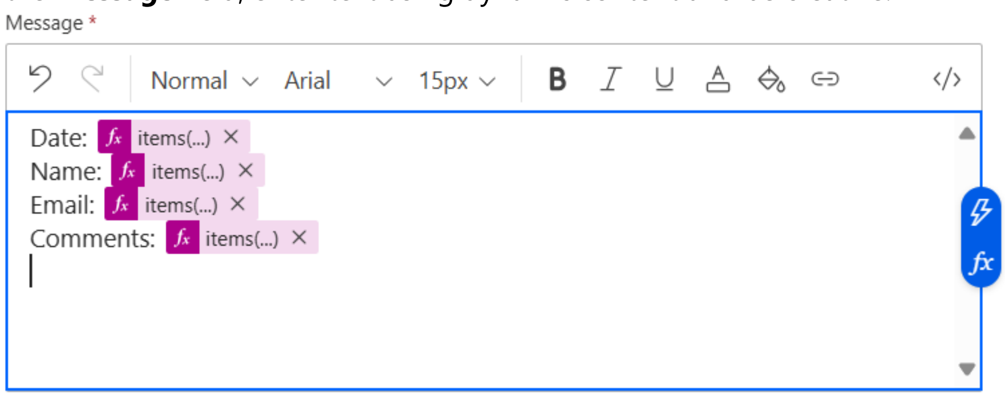
Task 2: Send a Teams Message to Yourself

1. Add a new step:
   Microsoft Teams → Post message in a chat or channel
   Choose Post as: **User**,
   and Post in: **Group chat**,
   under Group Chat input→ Enter Custom Value: 48:notes

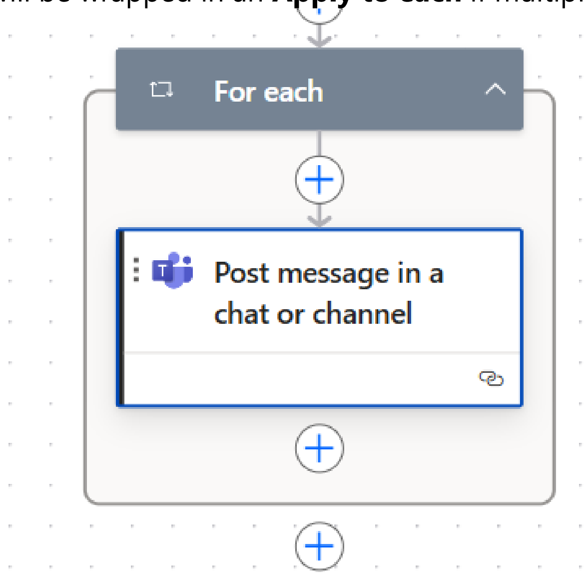
This sends a message to yourself in Teams.



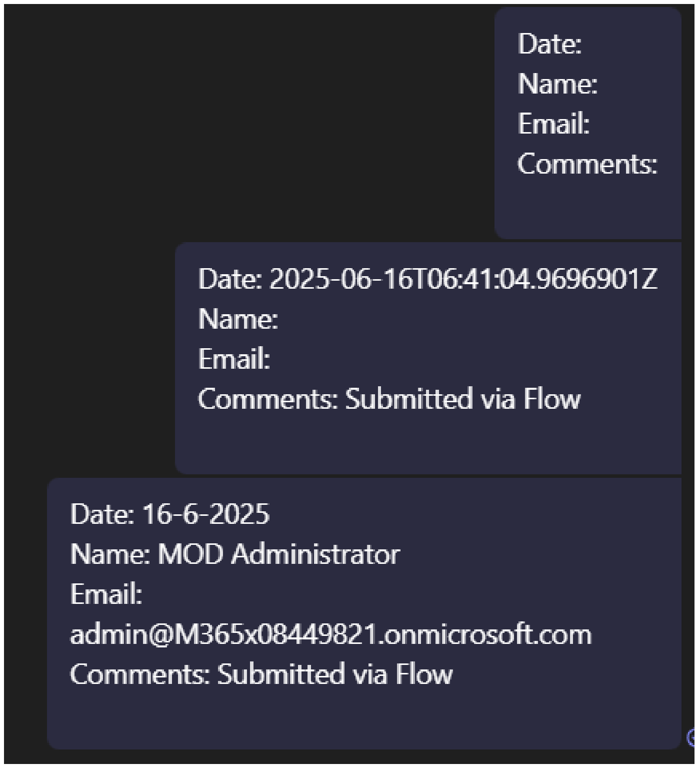
3. In the **Message** field, enter text using dynamic content and be creative.



(Note: This step will be wrapped in an **Apply to each** if multiple rows are present.)



4. Save and test the flow. Open Microsoft Teams and confirm that messages were sent to yourself.



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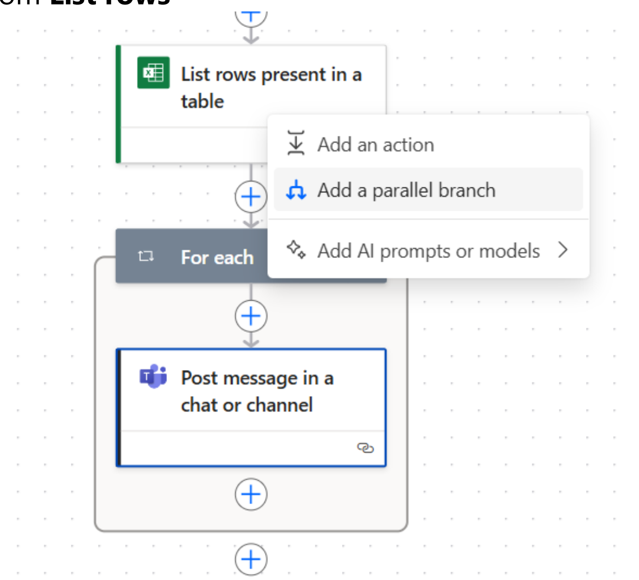
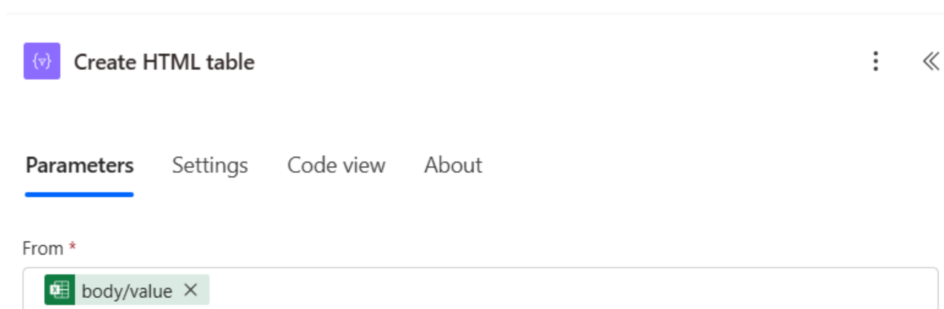
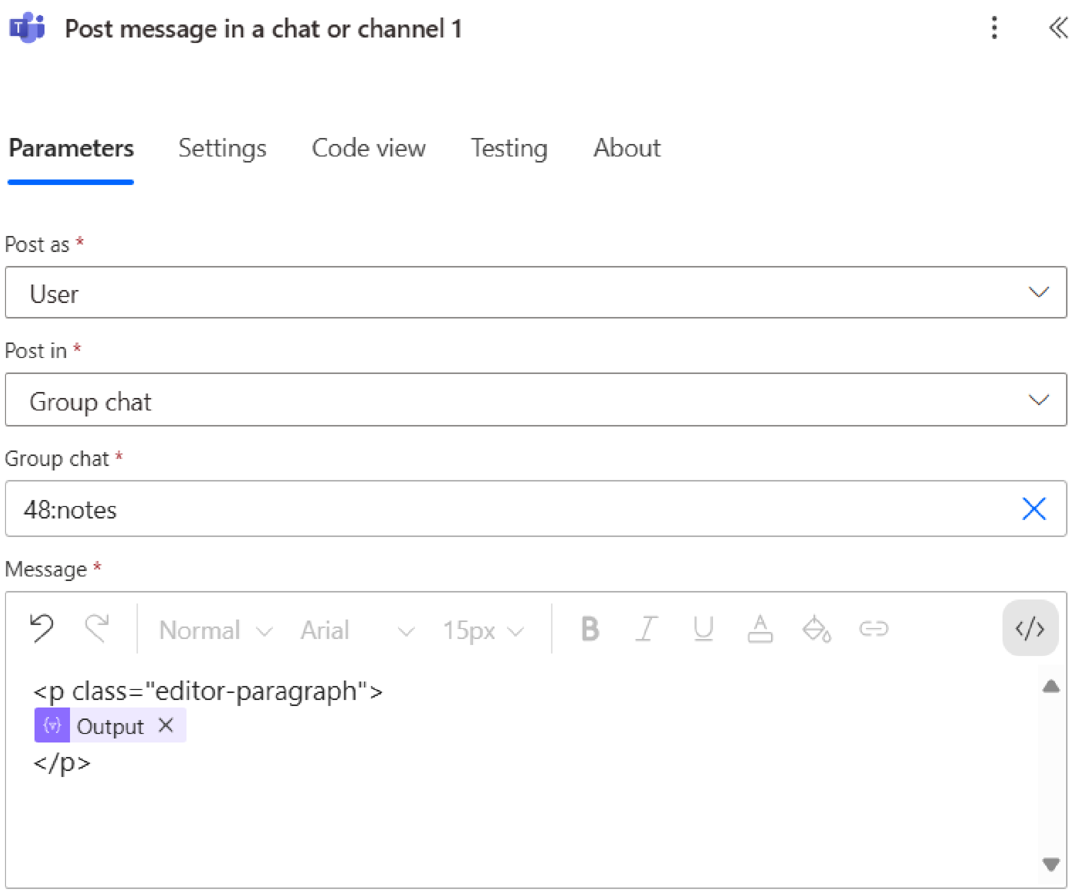
Optional Task: Use HTML Table Instead of Multiple Messages

1. Right click and Add a parallel branch step before the Teams message: **Create HTML Table**
   Input: output from **List rows**

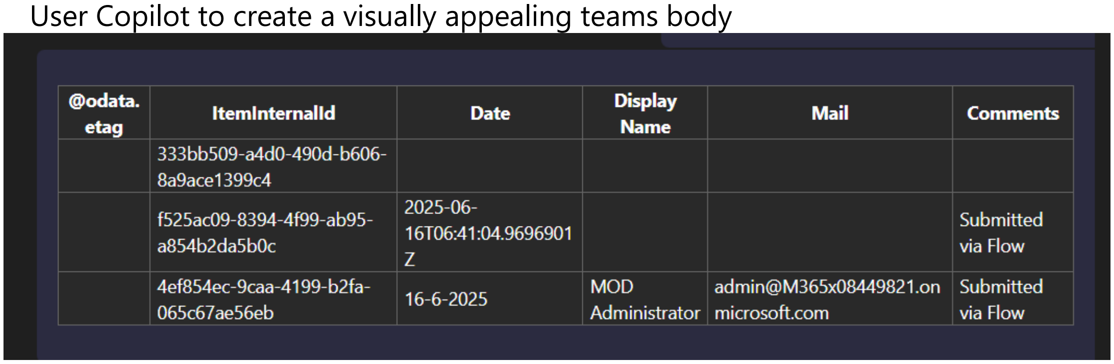




2. Replace the **Teams message** content with the output of the **Create HTML Table** action (Note: Toggle code view in the Message toolbar to enable HTML formatting)



3. This will send one formatted table instead of multiple individual messages
4. Save and test again. Check that the table appears in Teams
   (Feel free to play around with the advanced options under create html table to adjust the headers and columns to show)
   User Copilot to create a visually appealing teams body



@odata.etag	ItemInternalId	Date	Display Name	Mail	Comments
	333bb509-a4d0-490d-b606-8a9ace1399c4				
	f525ac09-8394-4f99-ab95-a854b2da5b0c	2025-06-16T06:41:04.9696901Z			Submitted via Flow
	4ef854ec-9caa-4199-b2fa-065c67ae56eb	16-6-2025	MOD Administrator	admin@M365x08449821.onmicrosoft.com	Submitted via Flow

-- **End of Task** --

Microsoft Power Platform

Exercise 3: Automating Approvals from Microsoft Forms

In this exercise, participants will build an **automated flow** that is triggered by a Microsoft Form submission. The flow will send an approval request, and based on the outcome, a Teams message will be sent to the requester. This introduces the **Approvals connector**, conditional logic, and reuses the 48:notes technique from earlier exercises.

Objectives

After completing this exercise, participants will be able to:

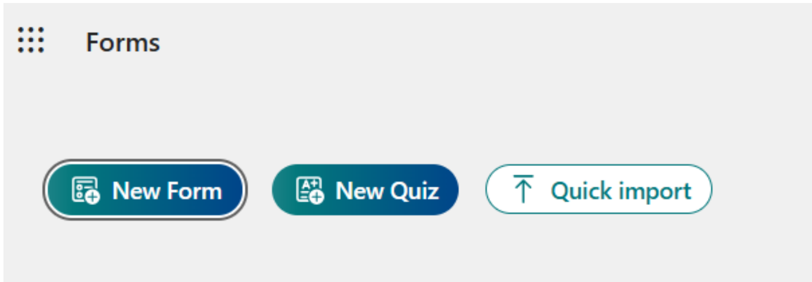
- Create an automated flow triggered by a Microsoft Form
- Use the **Start and wait for an approval** action
- Receive and respond to approval requests via Teams and email
- Add conditional logic based on approval outcome
- Send Teams notifications to themselves using 48:notes

Estimated Time

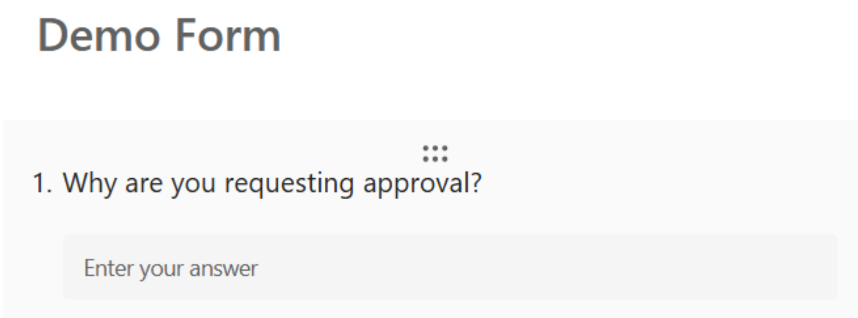
40–50 mins

Task 1: Create a Microsoft Form

1. Go to [Microsoft Forms]() and click **New Form**



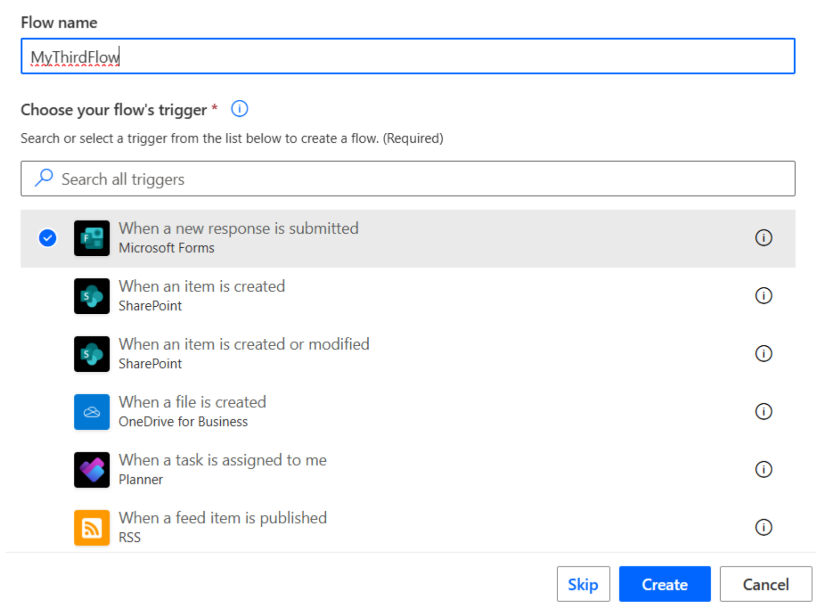
2. Name the form: **Demo Form**
3. Add a **single text question**, e.g.: "Why are you requesting approval?"



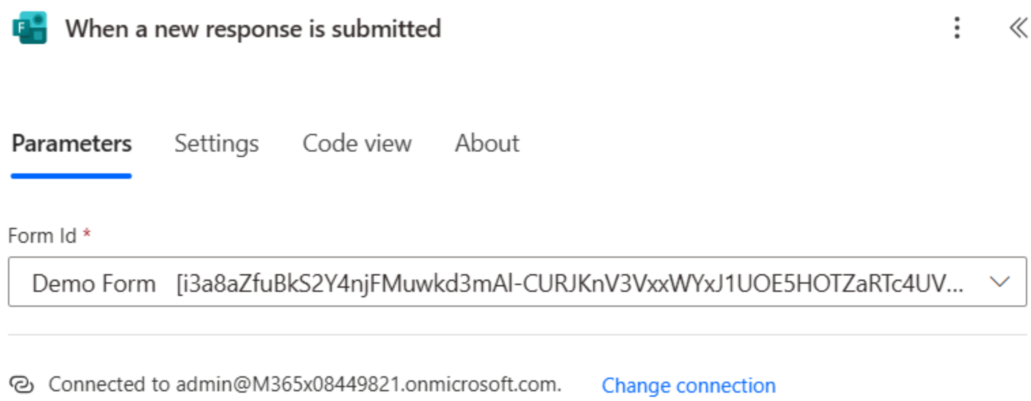
Task 2: Create an Automated Approval Flow

1. In Power Automate, go to **Create > Automated cloud flow**
2. Name the flow: **MyThirdFlow**

Choose trigger: **When a new response is submitted (Microsoft Forms)** Click **Create**



3. In the trigger step, select the Demo Form created earlier

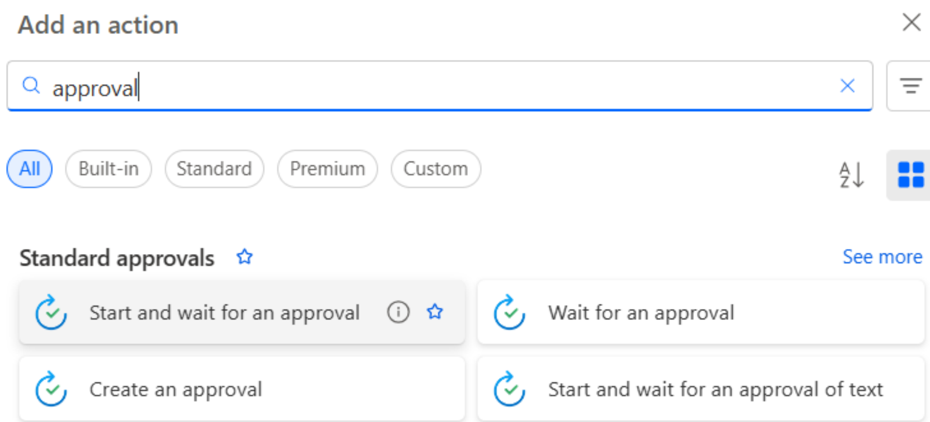


4. Add a new step:
   Get response details (Microsoft Forms)

- **Form ID**: Demo Form
- **Response ID**: Use dynamic content from the trigger

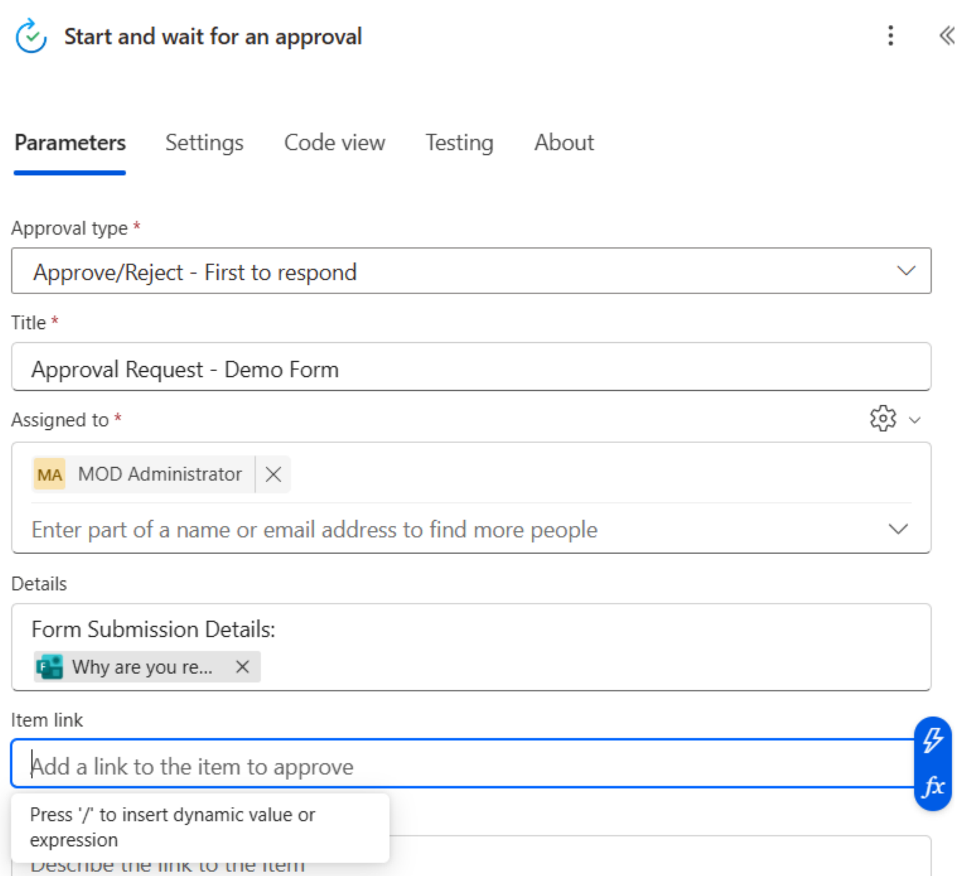
Task 3: Add the Approval Step

1. Add the **Start and wait for an approval** action



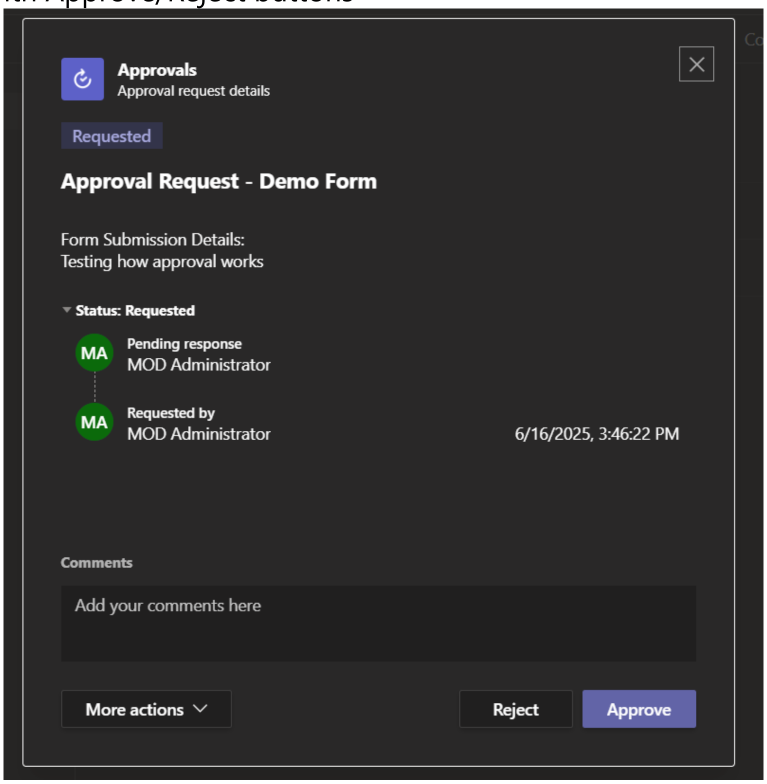
2. Configure the action as follows:

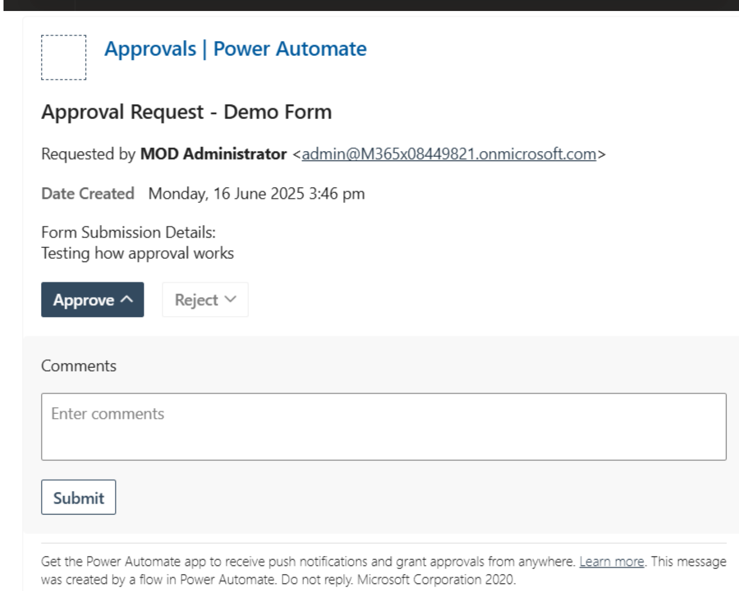
- **Approval type**: Approve/Reject – First to respond
- **Title**: Approval Request – Demo Form
- **Assigned to**: Enter your email
- **Details**: Insert dynamic content from the form response



3. Click **Save** and test by submitting the form
   You should receive:

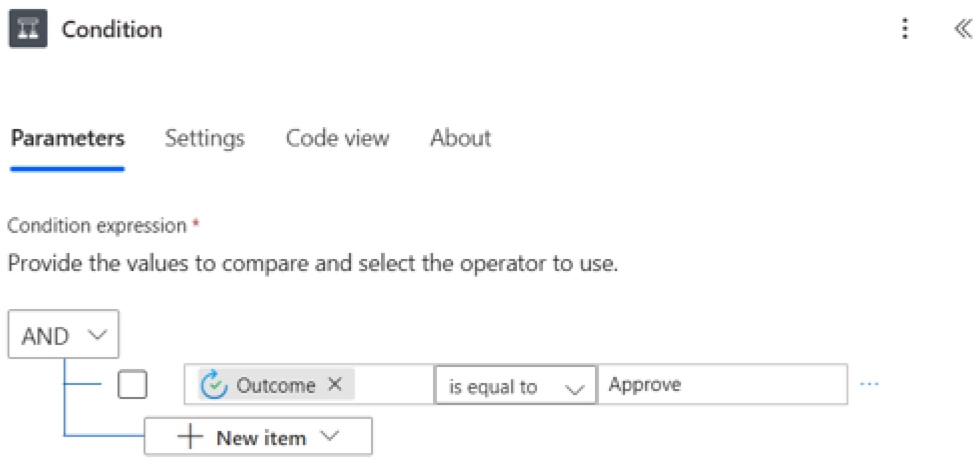
- A **Teams notification**
- An **email** with Approve/Reject buttons





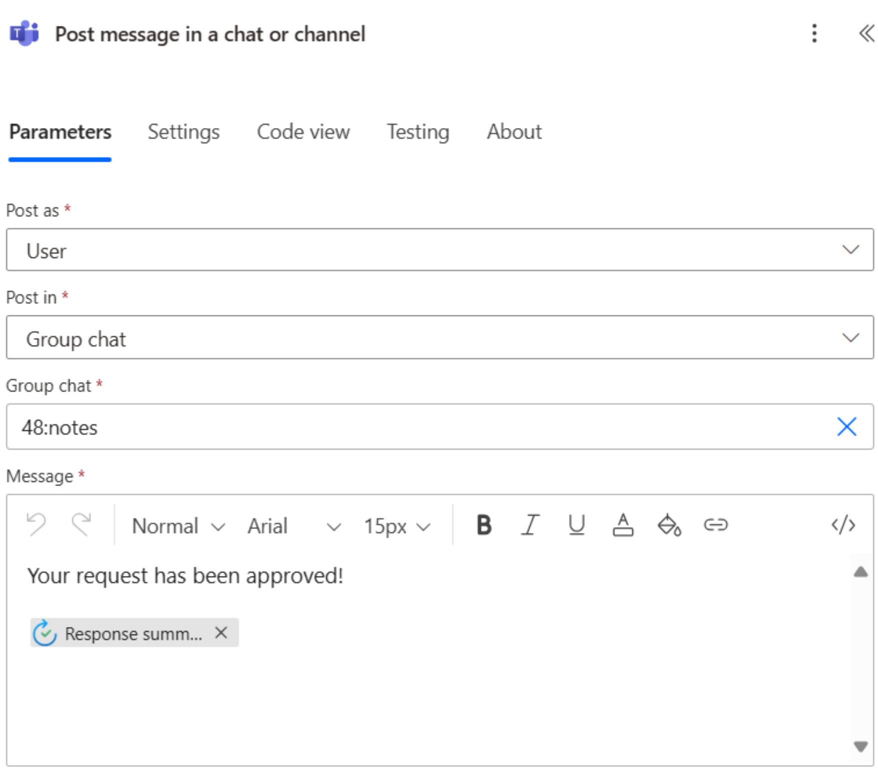
Task 4: Add Conditional Logic

1. Add a **Condition** control
   Set the condition: is equal to Approve

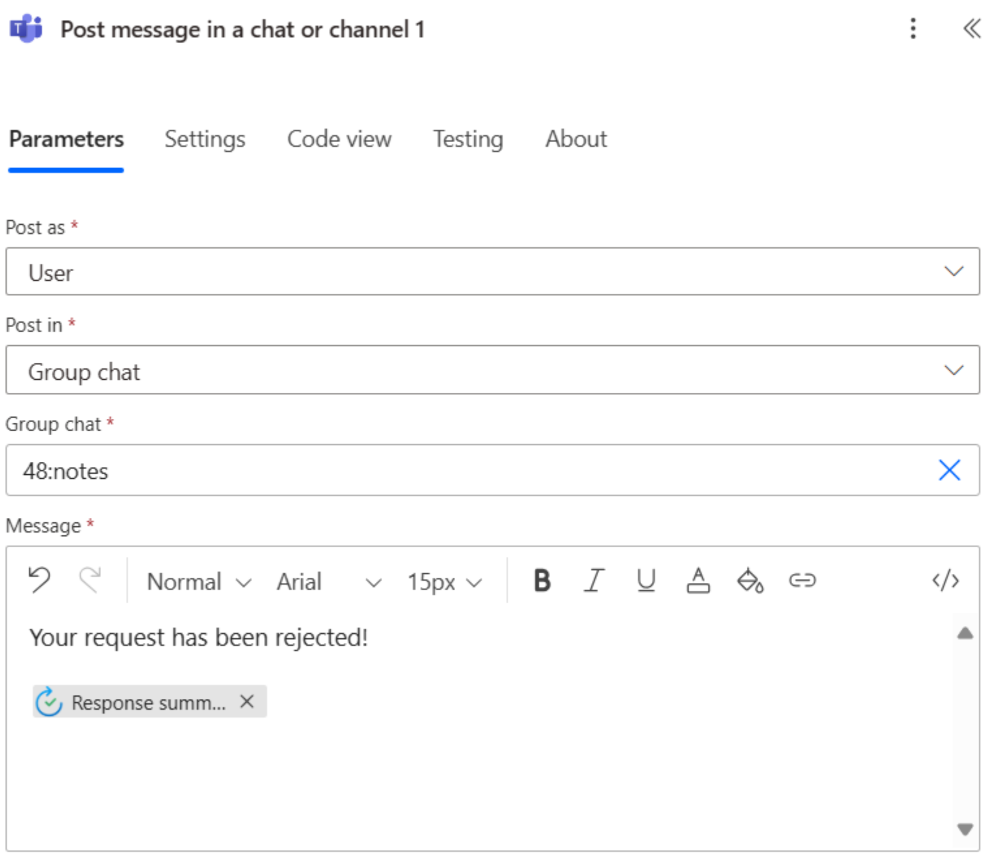


2. In the **If yes** branch, add:
   Microsoft Teams → Send message in a chat

- Recipient: 48:notes
- **Message**: "Your request has been approved!"

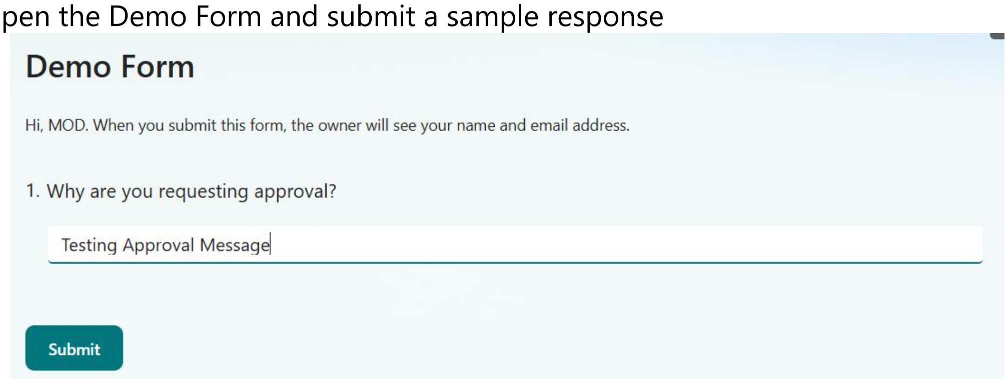


3. In the **If no** branch, add a similar message:

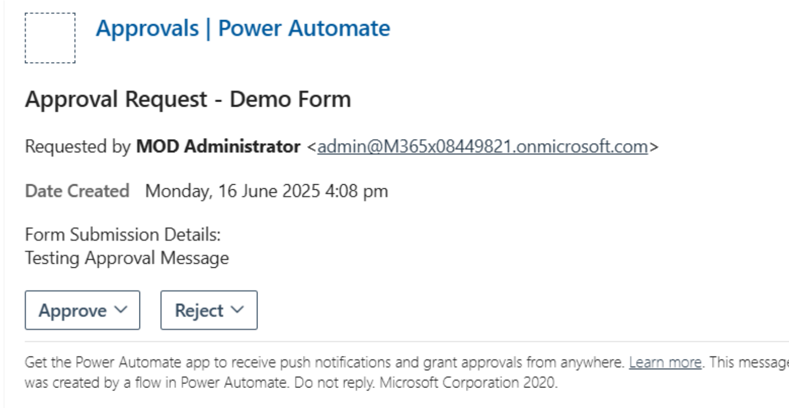


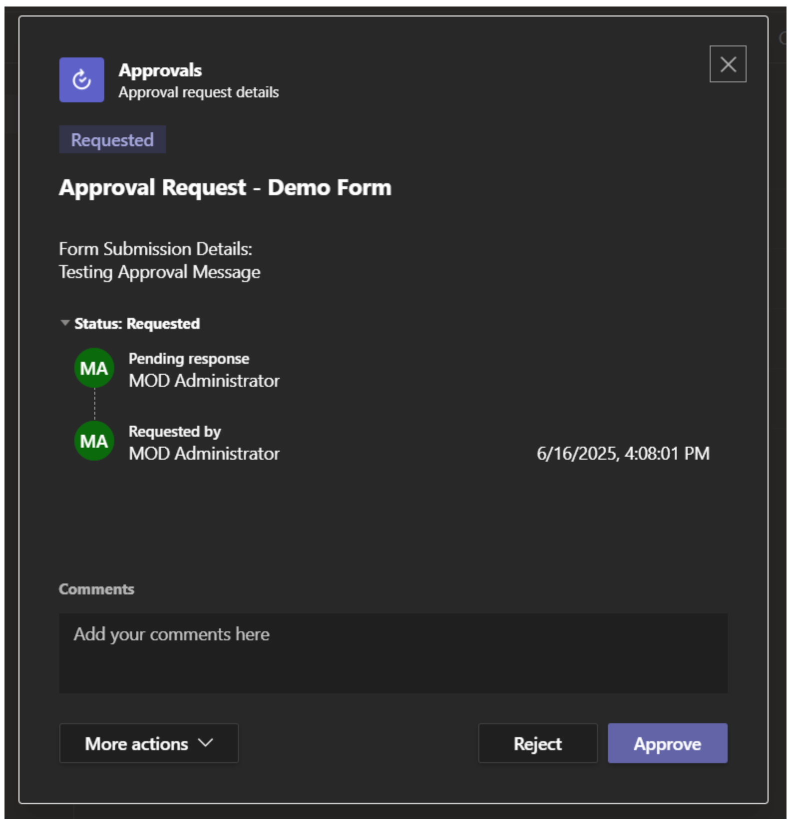
Task 5: Test and View the Outcome

1. Open the Demo Form and submit a sample response



2. Check your email and Microsoft Teams — you should receive an **approval request**





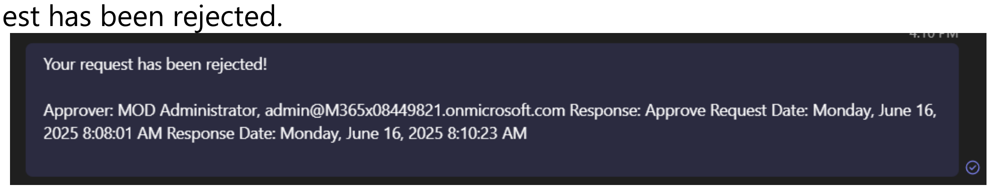
3. Click **Approve** or **Reject** from either channel
   Return to Teams and verify that the correct message was sent to yourself:

- If approved →

Your request has been approved! 🎉

- If rejected →

Your request has been rejected.



--- **End of Task** ---